

Simulating non-trivial incompressible flows with a quantum lattice Boltzmann algorithm

David Jennings, **Kamil Korzekwa**, Matteo Lostaglio, Paul Mannix



Richard Ashworth, Emanuele Marsili, Stephen Rolston



WHO ARE WE?

PsiQuantum

- A full-stack quantum company
- Employing 450+ experts
- With global presence in US, Europe and Australia



Mission: To build and deploy the first useful quantum computers

This means:

- Fault-tolerance: full error correction
- Large-scale: 1000000+ qubits

AGENDA

01 Motivation

CFD bottlenecks and beyond

02 Framework

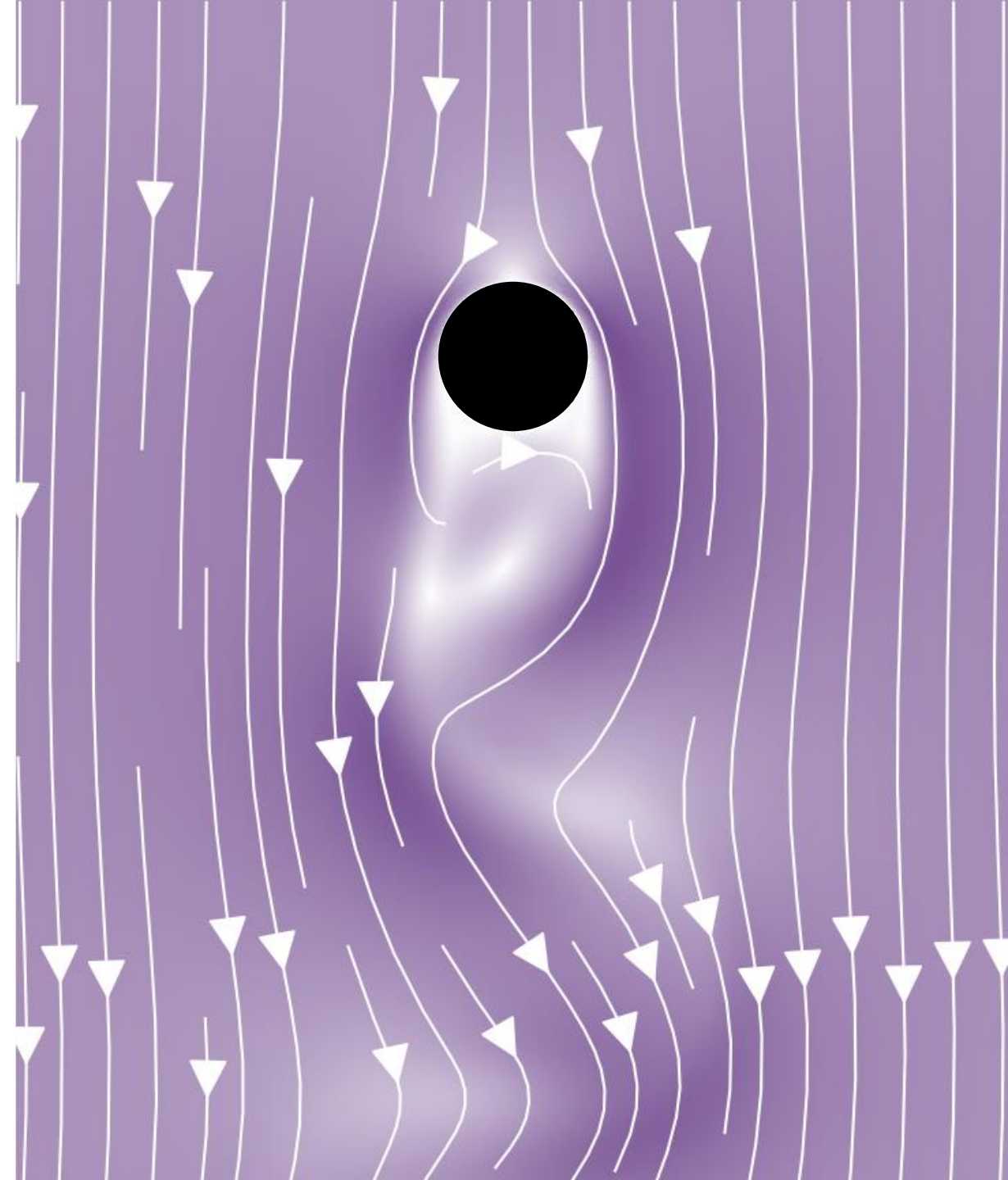
Quantum algorithms for CFD

03 Results

Performance of quantum LBE algorithm

04 Conclusions & outlook

Main takeaways & areas for improvement



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0 1 Motivation

CFD bottlenecks and beyond

- Classical CFD complexity
- Quantum CFD landscape

0 2 Framework

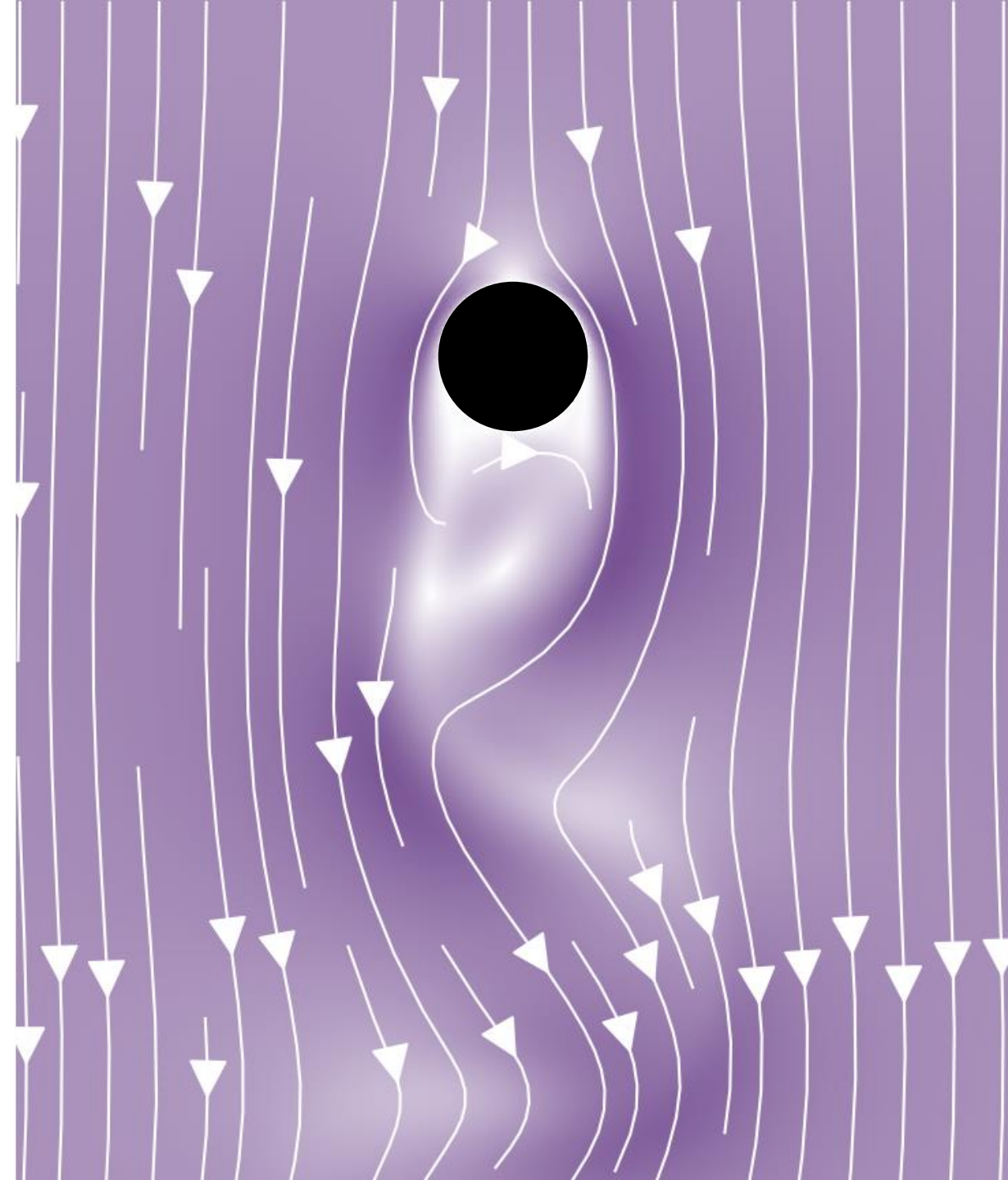
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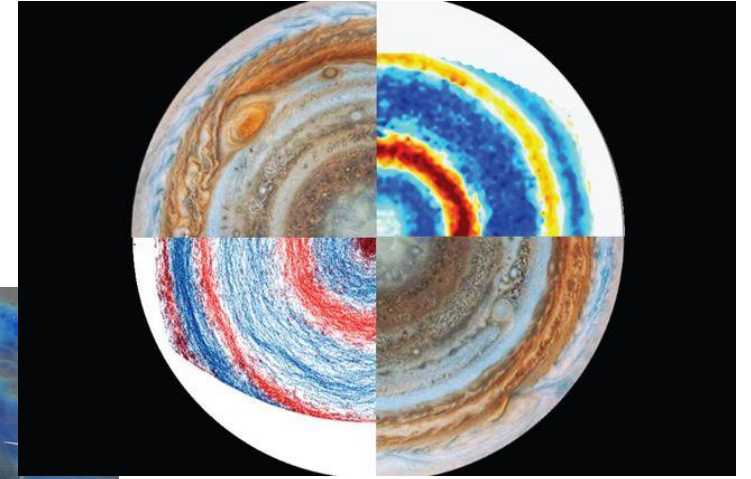
Main takeaways & areas for improvement



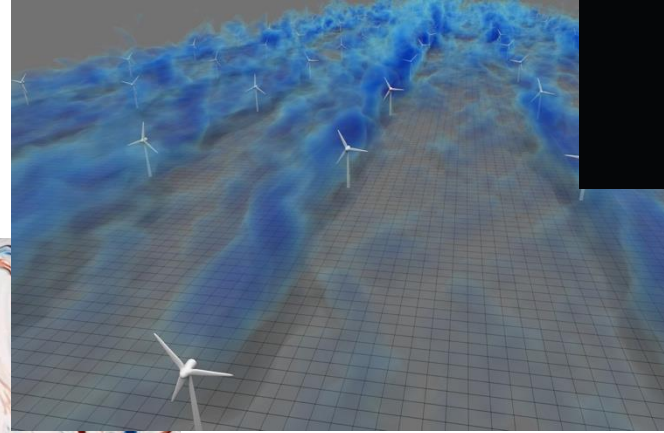
MOTIVATION

Classical CFD complexity

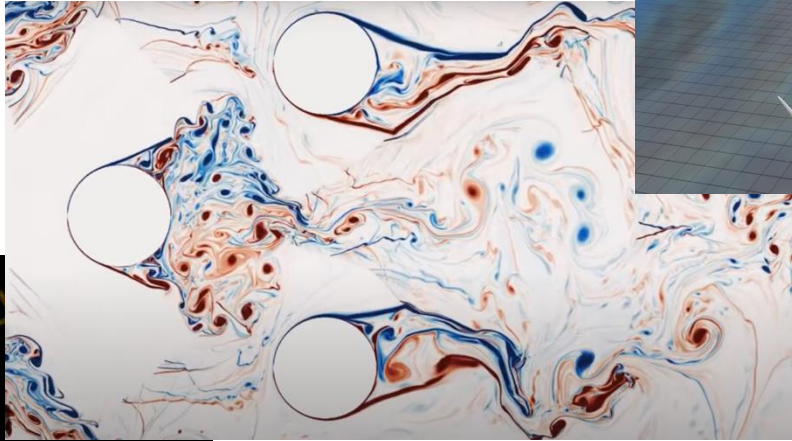
$$\text{Complexity}_C = O(\text{Re}^3)$$



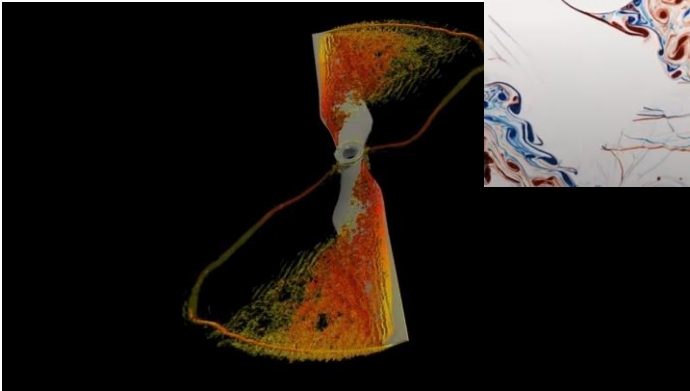
Experiment – Jupiter's jets
 $\text{Re} \sim 10^{10}$ (UCLA/IRPHE)



LES - wind farm $\text{Re} = 10^8$ (John Hopkins)



DNS - vortex shedding $\text{Re} = 2 \times 10^5$ (John Hopkins)



DNS - starting drone rotor $\text{Re} = 1.5 \times 10^4$ (FAU, KTH, KAUST)

MOTIVATION

Quantum CFD landscape

	Year	Analysis	Speed-up	Resource estimates	Accuracy	CFD apps
Potential quantum advantage for simulation of fluid dynamics Xiangyu Li,^{1,*} Xiaolong Yin,² Nathan Wiebe,^{3,1,4} Jaehun Chun,^{1,5} Gregory K. Schenter,¹ Margaret S. Cheung,^{1,6} and Johannes Mülmenstädt^{1,†} ¹<i>Pacific Northwest National Laboratory, Richland, WA, USA</i> ²<i>Petroleum Engineering, Colorado School of Mines, Golden, CO, USA</i> ³<i>Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto, Toronto, ON, Canada</i> ⁴<i>Canadian Institute for Advanced Research, Toronto, ON, Canada</i> ⁵<i>Levich Institute and Department of Chemical Engineering, CUNY City College of New York, New York, NY, USA</i> ⁶<i>Department of Physics, University of Washington, Seattle, WA, USA</i>	2023	Initial 	None (claimed exp) 	Preliminary 	Unverified 	No 
Detailed assessment of calculating drag force with quantum computers: Explicit time-evolution precludes exponential advantage for nonlinear differential equations John Penuel¹, Amara Katabarwa^{2,3}, Peter D. Johnson³, Parker Kuklinski⁴, Benjamin Rempfer⁴, Collin Farquhar³, Yudong Cao^{3,6}, and Michael C. Garrett^{1†} ¹<i>L3Harris Technologies, Inc., Palm Bay, FL, USA</i> ²<i>Georgia Tech Research Institute, Atlanta, GA, USA</i> ³<i>Zapata AI, Boston, MA, USA</i> ⁴<i>MIT Lincoln Laboratory, Lexington, MA, USA</i> ⁶<i>Boston Consulting Group, 200 Pier 4 Blvd, Boston, MA</i>	2024	Flawed end-to-end 	Modest poly 	Partial 	Unverified 	No 
An end-to-end quantum algorithm for nonlinear fluid dynamics with bounded quantum advantage David Jennings¹, Kamil Korzekwa^{*1}, Matteo Lostaglio¹, Richard Ashworth², Emanuele Marsili², and Stephen Rolston² ¹<i>PsiQuantum, 700 Hansen Way, Palo Alto, CA 94304, USA</i> ²<i>Airbus Operations Ltd, Pegasus House Aerospace Avenue, Filton, Bristol, UK</i> Simulating non-trivial incompressible flows with a quantum lattice Boltzmann algorithm David Jennings[*], Kamil Korzekwa^{*1}, Matteo Lostaglio[*], and Paul Mannix^{*†} <i>PsiQuantum, 700 Hansen Way, Palo Alto, CA 94304, USA</i> Richard Ashworth[‡], Emanuele Marsili[§], and Stephen Rolston[§] <i>Airbus Operations Ltd, Pegasus House Aerospace Avenue, Filton, Bristol, UK</i>	2025	End-to-end 	Modest poly 	Complete 	Partially confirmed 	Yes 

This talk

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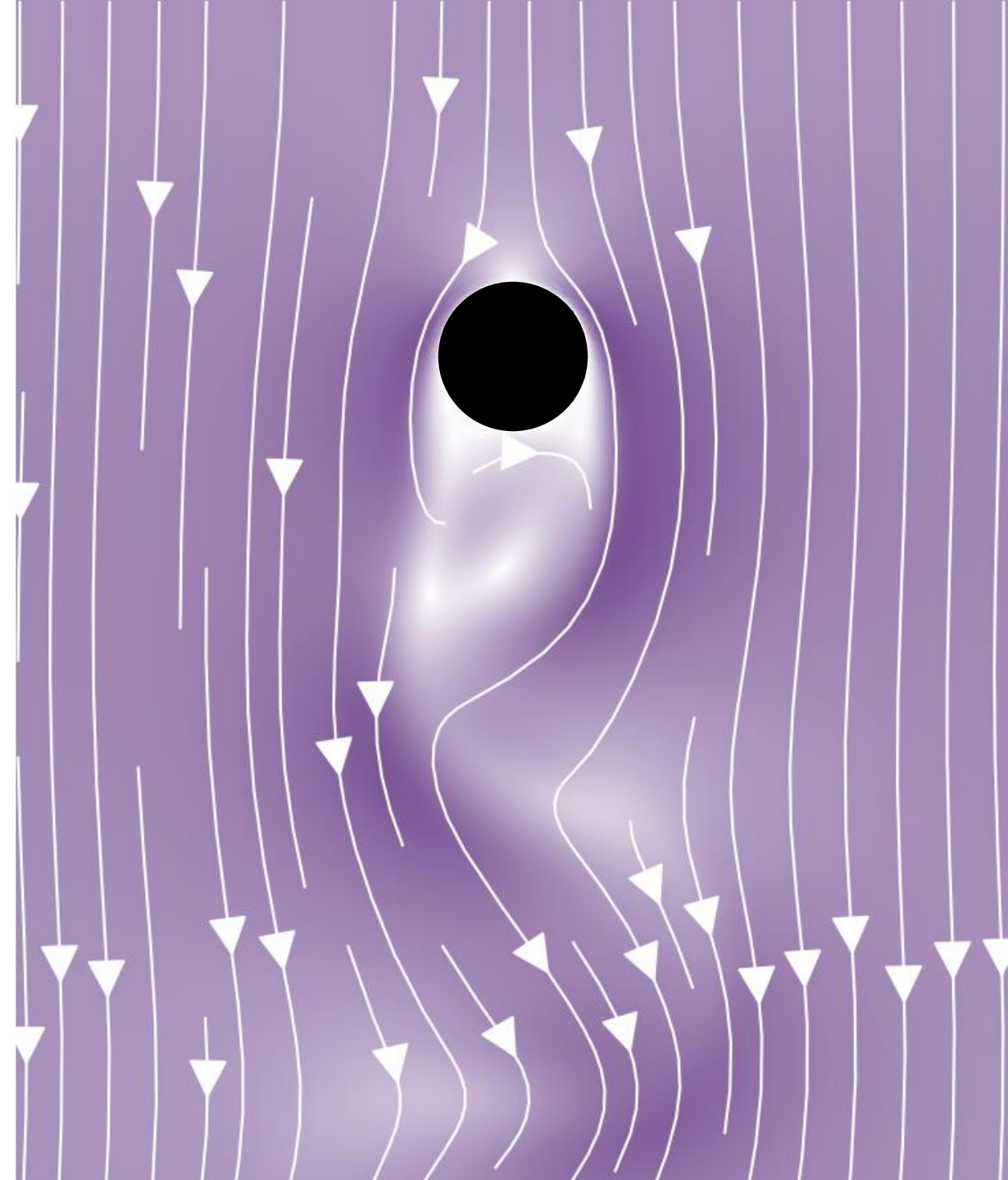
- Origin of quantum speedup
- Pipeline for nonlinear differential equations
- Quantum lattice Boltzmann method

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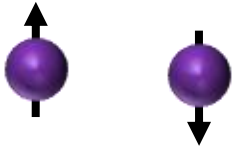


FRAMEWORK

Origin of quantum speedup

Quantum data encoding

Single two-level system (qubit):



Its state:

$$\Psi = \alpha_1 \uparrow + \alpha_2 \downarrow$$

Probability amplitudes
($|\alpha_1|^2 + |\alpha_2|^2 = 1$)

N qubits:

$$\Psi = (\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_{2^N})$$

Encode exponentially many amplitudes

Quantum data processing

Unitary evolution of Ψ under the Schrodinger equation:

$$i\hbar \frac{d}{dt} \Psi = H \Psi$$

Exponential quantum speedup for quantum simulations

Caveats

Evolution is linear



Linear embedding

Evolution is unitary



Unitary encoding

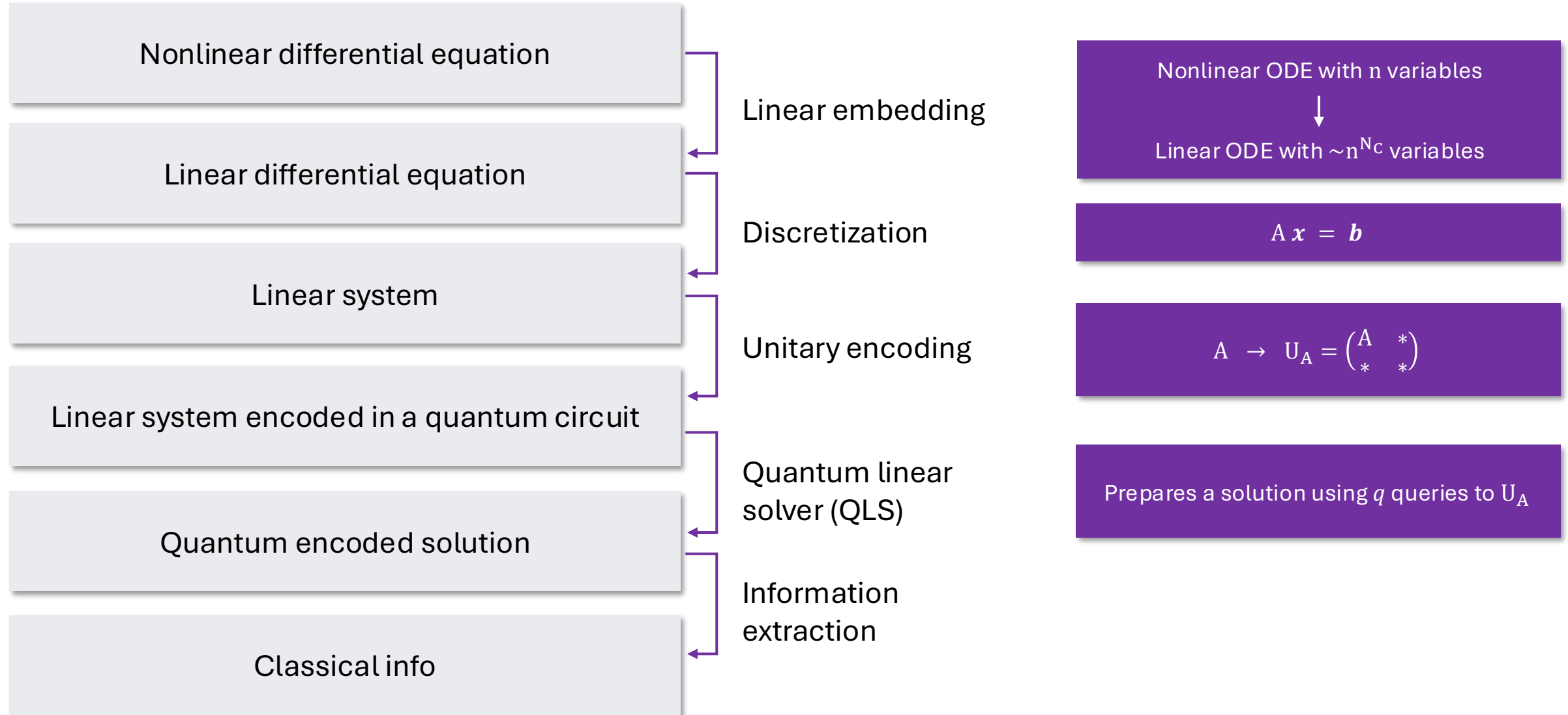
Readout problem



Info extraction subroutine

FRAMEWORK

Pipeline for nonlinear differential equations



FRAMEWORK

Quantum lattice Boltzmann method

Incompressible Navier-Stokes equations (nonlinearity scales with Re)

Momentum equation $\partial_t \mathbf{u} + (\mathbf{u} \cdot \nabla) \mathbf{u} = -\nabla p + \nu \Delta \mathbf{u} + \mathbf{F}$

Mass conservation $\nabla \cdot \mathbf{u} = 0$

$\mathbf{u}$ – velocity field

p – pressure field

ν – kinematic viscosity

$\mathbf{F}$ – external force

Discrete-Boltzmann equation (nonlinearity scales with Ma)

$$\partial_t f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) + \mathbf{e}_m \cdot \nabla f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) = \Omega_m(\mathbf{r}, t)$$

$\mathbf{e}_m \cdot \nabla f_m(\mathbf{r}, t)$ – streaming term

$\Omega_m(\mathbf{r}, t)$ – collision term

$f_m(\mathbf{r}, t)$ – discretized density of particles

$\mathbf{e}_m$ – unit velocity in direction $m \in \{1, \dots, Q\}$

$Q = 3/9/27$ – number of unit velocities available in 1D/2D/3D

$$p = c_s^2 \sum_{m=1}^Q f_m(\mathbf{r}, t)$$

$$\mathbf{u}(\mathbf{r}, t) = \frac{1}{\rho_0} \sum_{m=1}^Q f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) \cdot \mathbf{e}_m$$

FRAMEWORK

Quantum lattice Boltzmann method

Discretize space and time to obtain the lattice Boltzmann equation

$$\partial_t f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) + \mathbf{e}_m \cdot \nabla f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) = -\frac{1}{\tau} [f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) - f_m^{\text{eq}}(\mathbf{r}, t)]$$

$$f_m(\mathbf{r} + \mathbf{e}_m \Delta t, t + \Delta t) = f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) - \frac{\Delta t}{\tau + \Delta t/2} [f_m(\mathbf{r}, t) - f_m^{\text{eq}}(\mathbf{r}, t)]$$

Reformulate $f_m(\mathbf{r}, t)$ to only depend on t

$$f(t^*) = \sum_{\mathbf{r}^*} \sum_{m=1}^Q f_m(\mathbf{r}^*, t^*) |\mathbf{r}^*\rangle \otimes |m\rangle$$

$$\mathbf{r} = \mathbf{r}^* \Delta x$$

$$t = t^* \Delta t$$

Divide the integrated equation into streaming and collision distributions and apply Carleman

$$f^c(t^*) = (1 + F_1)f(t^*) + F_2 f(t^*)^{\otimes 2}$$

$$f(t^* + 1) = S f^c(t^*)$$

F_1, F_2 – linear and quadratic collision matrices

S – permutation matrix encoding streaming

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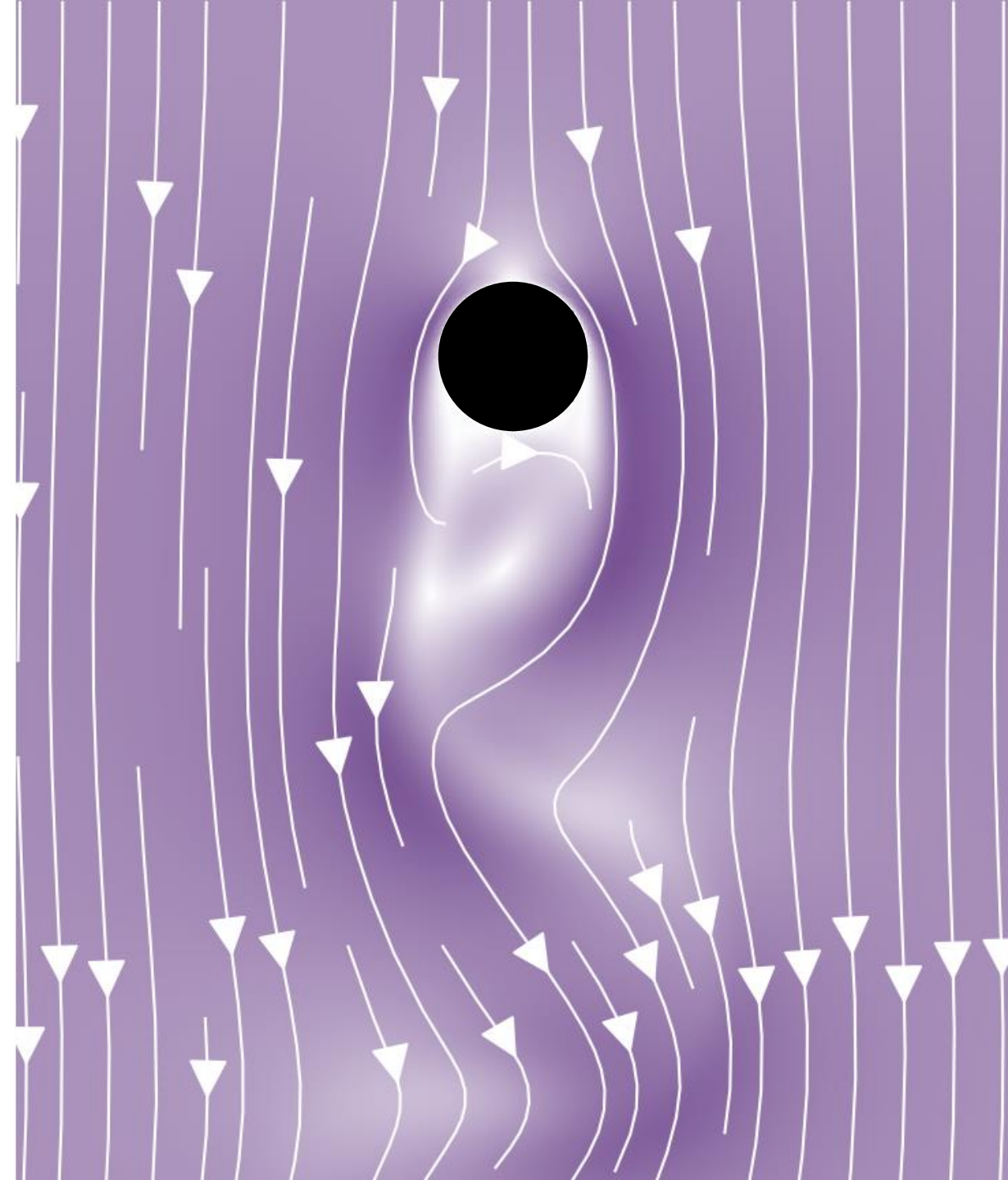
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Performance of quantum LBE algorithm

- Central questions & benchmark problems
- Linear embedding accuracy
- Quantum speedup

0 4 Conclusions & outlook

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RESULTS

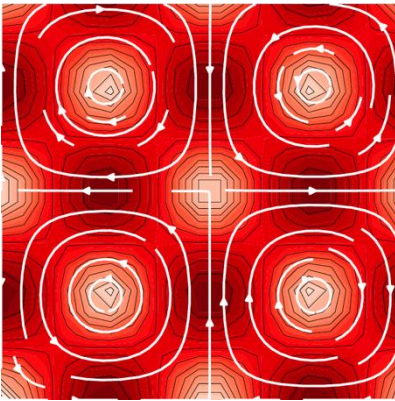
Central questions & benchmark problems

Central questions

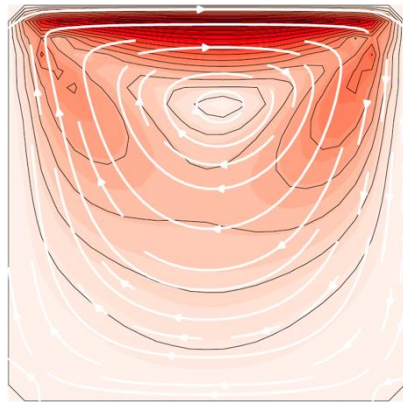
Linear embedding accuracy: how does the embedding error behave with growing N_c ?

Quantum speedup: how does the quantum computational complexity grow with Re ?

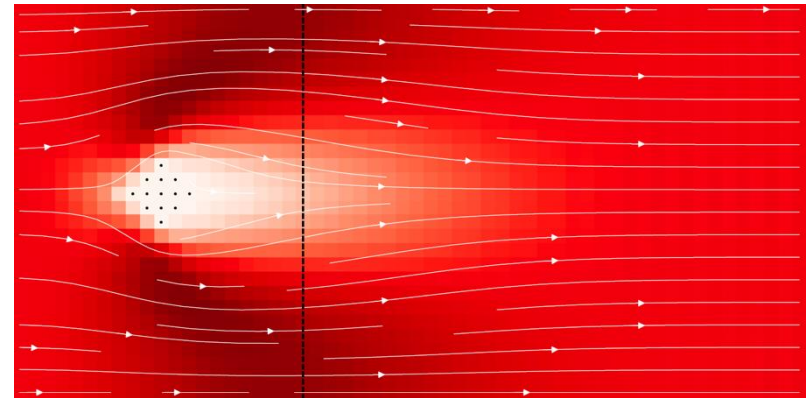
Benchmark problems



Driven Taylor-Green vortex



Lid-driven cavity flow



Flow past a cylinder

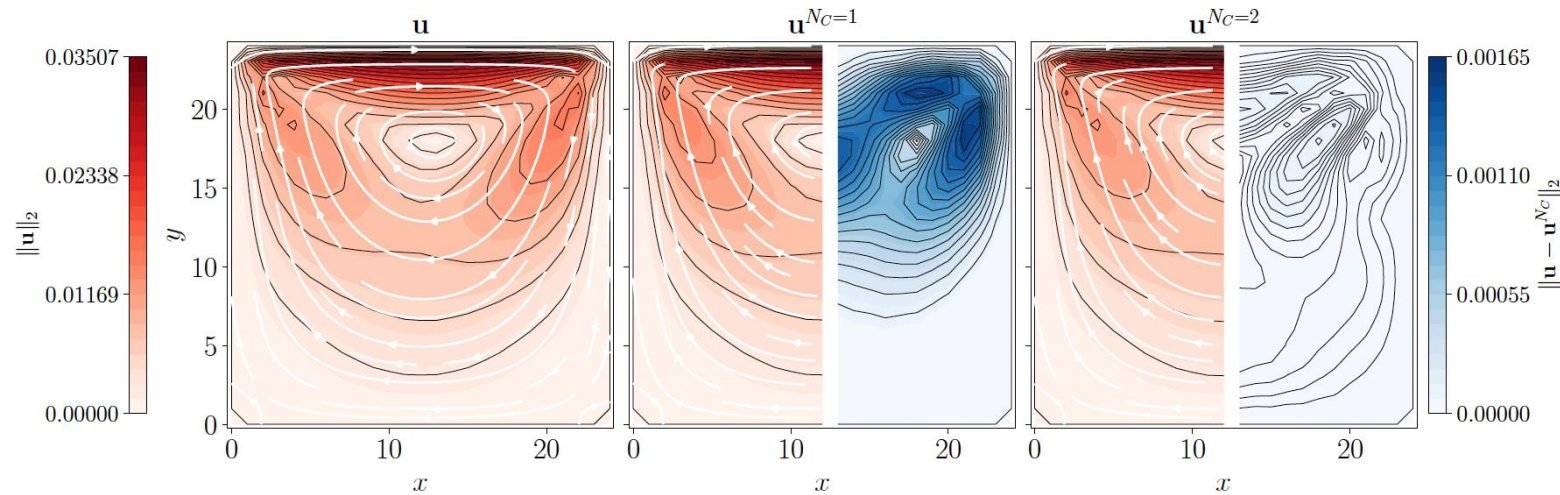
RESULTS

Linear embedding accuracy

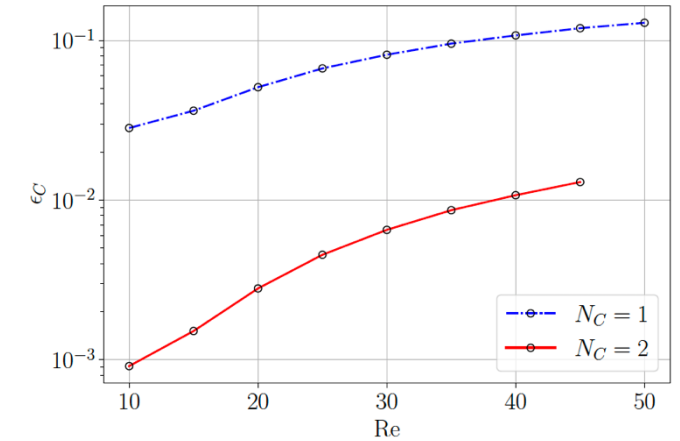
Embedding error measures

$$\epsilon_{rel}(t) := \frac{\|\mathbf{u}^{N_C}(t) - \mathbf{u}(t)\|}{\|\mathbf{u}(t)\|} \quad \epsilon_C(t) := \max_t \epsilon_{rel}(t)$$

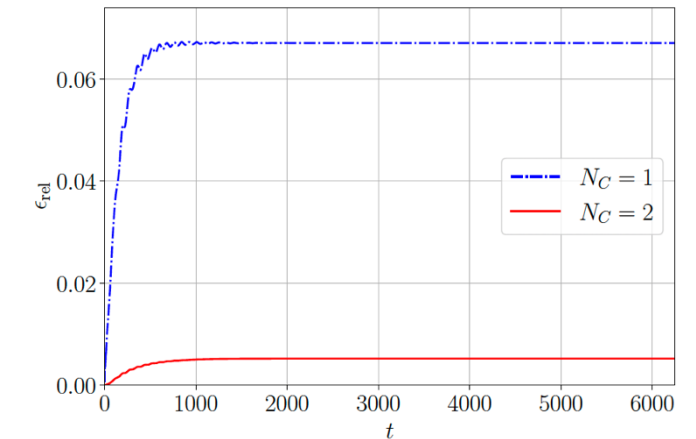
Steady state spatial embedding error for lid-driven cavity flow



Embedding error convergence



Embedding error boundedness



RESULTS

Quantum speedup

Quantum complexity contributions

- Initial state preparation
- Block-encoding U_A of the linear system A
- Solving the linear system A
- Information extraction

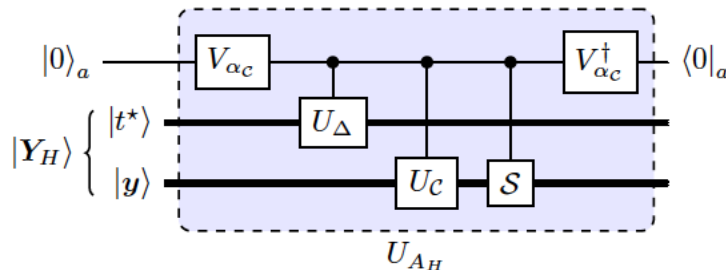
$$\text{Complexity}_Q = g \times q \times q_M$$

Number of gates
in a circuit U_A

Number of circuits
 U_A used by QLS

Measurement
info extraction cost

Compiled the core parts of the circuit to
show that g brings just a constant overhead



For drag force: $q_M = O(Re^{3/8})$

For bulk observables expecting: $q_M = O(1)$

Query complexity q is the
main complexity factor

RESULTS

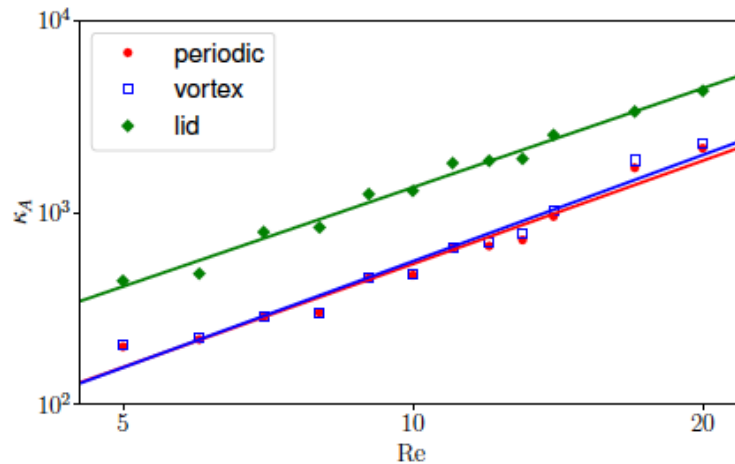
Quantum speedup

Complexity lower bound

$$\text{Complexity}_Q \geq \text{Re}^{\frac{3}{4}(1+\frac{D}{2})} \quad \text{vs} \quad \text{Complexity}_C = \text{Re}^{\frac{3}{4}(1+D)}$$

At most lower-than-quadratic speedup

Numerical complexity estimate



For 2D problem with $N_C = 2$:

$$\text{Complexity}_Q \simeq \text{Re}^{1.777} \times q_M$$

Modest quantum speedup

Bulk observables: Speedup $\simeq \text{Re}^{0.473}$

Drag force: Speedup $\simeq \text{Re}^{0.098}$

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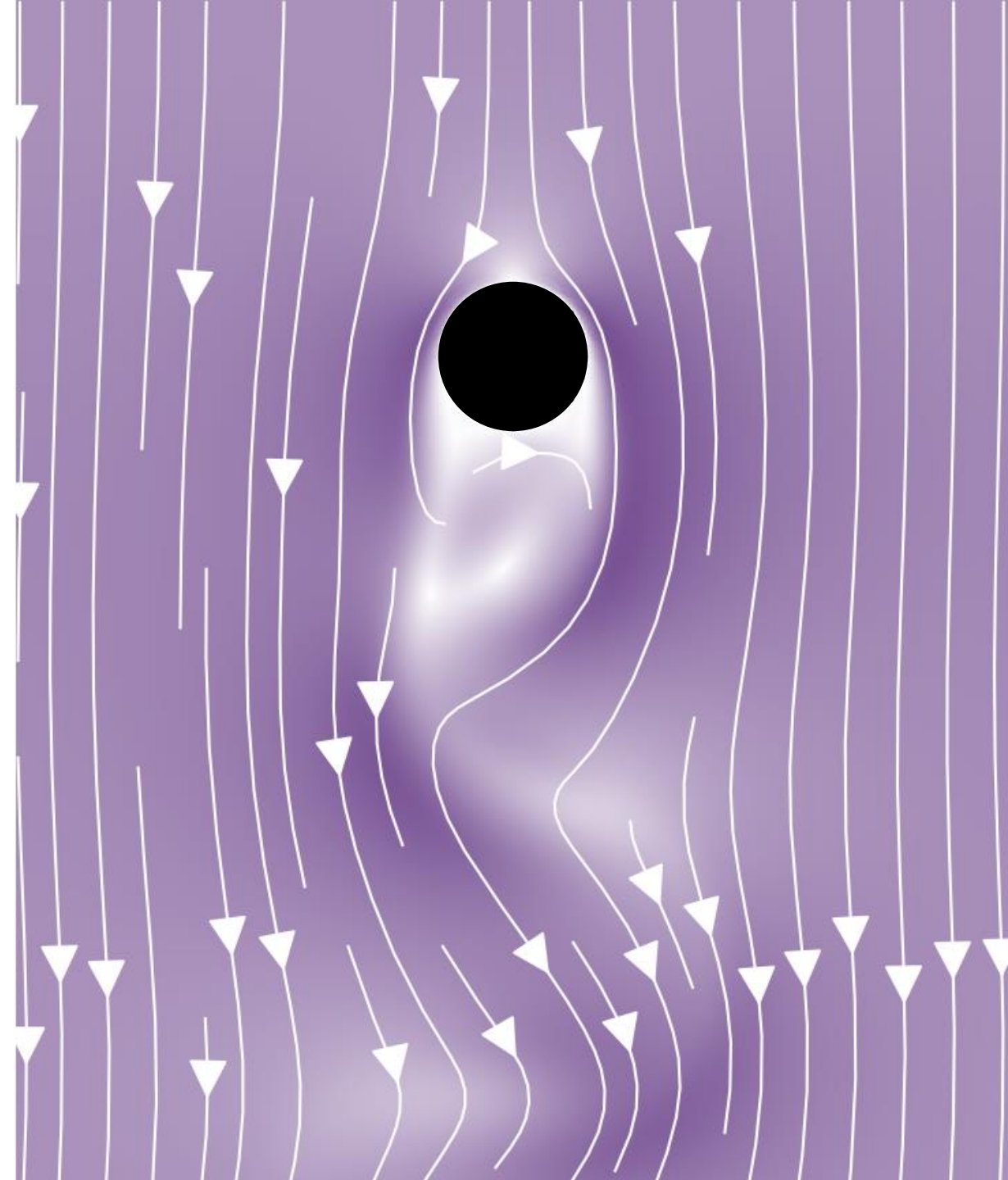
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CONCLUSIONS & OUTLOOK

Main takeaways & areas for improvement

Carleman linear embedding method converges for benchmark CFD problems

Next steps:

- Code optimization
- GPU acceleration
- Analytical convergence proofs
- Alternative linear embeddings

Modest quantum speedup for CFD problems is in principle possible

Next steps:

- Preconditioning methods
- Novel quantum linear solvers
- More efficient observables

Thank you!

